

Identity in Christ: Who You Are in Him

The gospel does not just change what you do, it changes the name you answer to.

Text. Selected texts on union with Christ

Good for. Believers who still measure themselves by the old verdict

The arc. Before the gospel tells you what to do, it tells you who you are, and getting that order wrong wrecks both. This series walks through the new identity given in Christ, from child to new creation to chosen people, so that obedience flows from belonging rather than toward it.

1. Children of God

John 1:9-13

Big idea. To all who received Him He gave the right to become children of God, born not of human will but of God.

Aim. To settle the hearer's standing as a child before they try to act like one.

Notes

2. No Condemnation

Romans 8:1-17

Big idea. For those in Christ Jesus there is no condemnation, and the Spirit testifies that we are heirs who cry Father.

Aim. To silence the hearer's inner verdict with the verdict of God.

Notes

3. A New Creation

2 Corinthians 5:14-21

Big idea. Anyone in Christ is a new creation, reconciled to God and made an ambassador of the reconciliation they received.

Aim. To free the hearer from a past God has already declared finished.

Notes

4. Hidden With Christ

Colossians 3:1-17

Big idea. Our life is hidden with Christ in God, and we put on the new self because of who we already are, not to become it.

Aim. To ground the hearer's daily change in an identity already secured.

Notes

5. A Chosen People

1 Peter 2:9-10

Big idea. Once not a people, we are now a chosen race and a royal priesthood, called out of darkness to declare His praises.

Aim. To give the lonely hearer a people and a purpose they did not earn.

Notes

HOW TO USE THIS SERIES

These are starting points, not scripts. Each series gives you the arc, the divisions, and a working aim for every sermon, but the breakdown here is scaffolding you will take down once the text has done its own work in you. Read the whole book before you preach the first week of it. Let the passage divisions teach you where the seams actually are.

The text sets the agenda. Not the felt needs you arrived with, not the outline that looks clean on a slide, not the application you already know you want to land. Sit under the passage long enough for it to surprise you, and then preach what it says rather than what you planned. A big idea you did not have to fight for is usually one the text did not give you.